

excited on how promising the metaverse and its applications can be. As if like some fantasy, metaverse strides close enough to a future of



gaming that we always dreamed of at least once. Humans have always been social animals, and with metaverse and its concepts we are talking about warping straight into something that would force us to re-evaluate what we justify as social media and communities today. Even apart from the broader motif of the metaverse, the gaming-verse and games that ascend from it would certainly not always be the same as we conceive for the time being. For certain, games would allude a lot more to players given their introduction of a whole new dimension. For the first time, players can actually 'earn' some value by spending their time on a game, while the earning may not even be passive. For there might not exist boundaries to redefine yourself in this space, albeit digitised, to truly be what you wish to be as. These new aspects of surrealism, worth and independence might excogitate as the characteristics of a digital utopia for sure. Although only for the fact that it ain't.

As John Hanke (Founder/CEO of Niantic - the Pokemon Go company) puts it, *"It takes us away from what fundamentally makes us happy as human beings. We're biologically evolved to be present in our bodies and to be out in the world. The tech world that we've been living in, as exacerbated by Covid, is not healthy. We've picked up bad habits like kids spending all day playing Roblox or whatever. And we're extrapolating that."*

The fundamental idea behind metaverse deeply resonates with this for its immense real-time presence in the real world. This means that

metaverse in existence will be present side-by-side for every individual to access, anytime they wish to. And when you take into account the fact that this very presence also offers utopian-like services to have you glued to their applications and games, things start to look pretty concerning. Addiction to games is pretty common even during the current time. As the metaverse affiliated new games show up, the chances are pretty vehement that it will keep a major portion of the population hooked up for a pretty sweet amount of time. This is again very alarming



because of the mental, physical and economical effects that it will wreak. This very ubiquitous yet piquant presence of the metaverse is what makes it both a boon and a bane.

Parting Note

As of almost till the last few months, the idea of a vast space at the intersection of the digital and physical worlds imbued with storytelling, and functionality might have sounded ridiculously like a dream. But when Meta came up front to present us the flare and possibility of achieving metaverse, it was like a soft nudge to drag us to this awe-inspiring reality. The very thought of having even a remote experience of the virtual reality as portrayed in movies and sequels, is enough to make us feel like living on the edge of a time which is advancing towards a utopian future. Meeting people without having to physically meet them in-person comes so natural to us, thanks to our locked-down-lives revolving

around it, that we forget to take our time to step back and appreciate this marvelous system at play. Similarly the metaverse has been around us, slithering in the shadows, waiting to be confronted, without us realising its presence.

As Mithun "barbarian_monkey" Mohandas once said, *"The Metaverse isn't a new concept that Meta introduced to the world. The Enterprise Technology space has been using similar technologies on the factory floor for a couple of years now."* But while the concept in itself is not something new, the substantial and sustainable

delivery that is being delivered, least even appearing possible, just leaves us in awe of what is to come next.

But beyond that idea, will the metaverse completely change the existing experiences and never let us look back? Well, we don't think so. While it's true that what metaverse

will bring to the table is something we never experienced before, there would still be an insane amount of time before people actually get to experience it at a fully functional state, and even more time to start getting the hang of it. The shift that we talked about above is also not something that would happen in a day or two, but probably in years! VR and AR have been around us for quite some time now, and while there have been claims of ground-breaking gaming experiences, we guess our grounds are made of obsidian. None of these claims have brought us any closer to a glimpse of 'Ready Player One' or 'Sword Art Online' like experience, but that is where Metaverse sounds promising. In fact it has less to do with the veridical experience and more with the concrete cardinal background upon which such virtual worlds can actually function. While there is always potential, we can only hold back and observe how well these latent possibilities are harvested. *